

1919–1928

MODERNISM

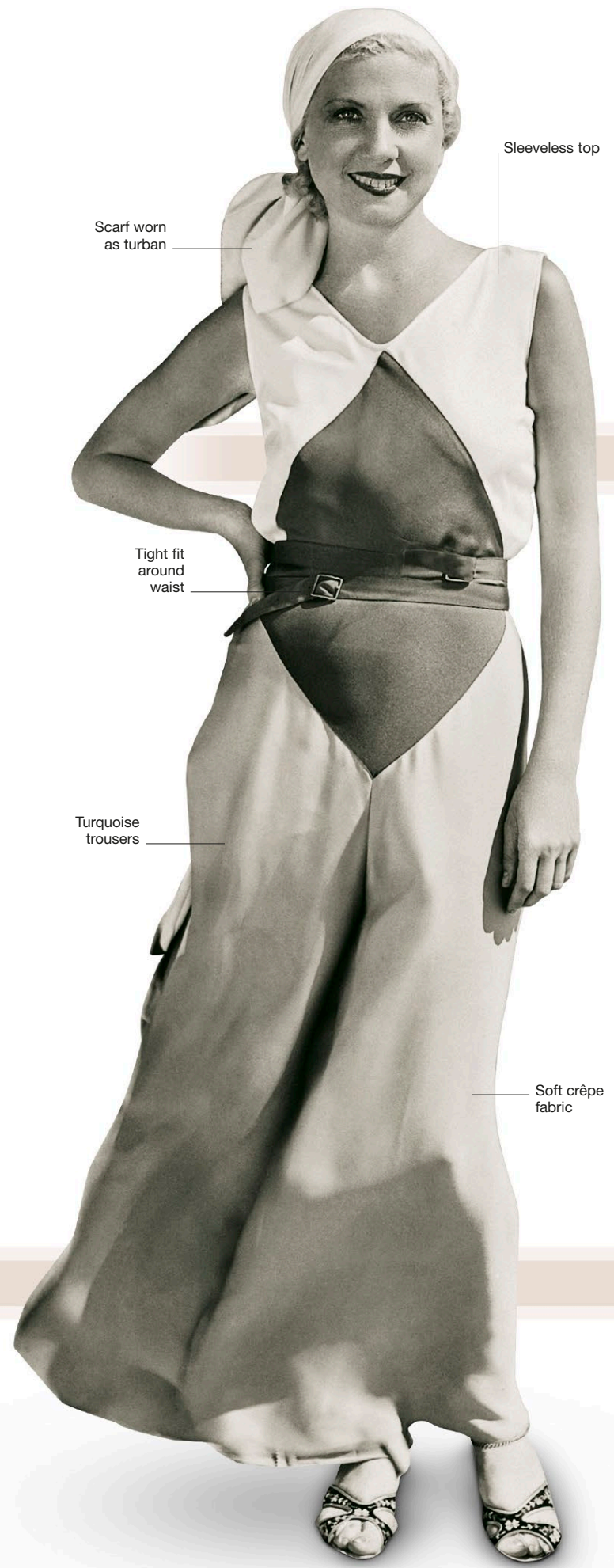
Some artists-turned-fashion creators were inspired by the past. Others, dotted around Europe and in post-revolutionary Russia, looked towards a variety of futures and created clothes for the new world. Aleksandr Rodchenko in Russia and Thayaht in Italy developed an early form of the functional overall, and Hungarian Laszlo Moholy-Nagy customized existing workwear. The Italian Futurists' love of speed and movement found expression not only in their art, but also in bright, one-off clothes with abstract patterns. Varvara Stepanova and Lyubov Popova designed textiles based on universal shapes to rationalize mass production in Russia. In Paris the Russian-born Sonia Delaunay also used geometric forms in bright colours but in the service of the moneyed few. That the straight silhouette of the 1920s lent itself to decoration with regular lines and shapes occurred to creative people besides artists, and similar designs could be found outside elite fashion.



TuTa In 1919 the artist and designer Ernesto Michahelles not only adopted the name Thayaht but also designed the TuTa, an early example of an overall. The soft lines created by this “universal garment” followed those of the body.



Work suit Between 1923 and 1928 the Hungarian Moholy-Nagy was a teacher at the German Bauhaus school. Its aim of fusing crafts and fine arts was echoed in his *Arbeitsanzug* (work suit), presenting the artist as craftsman.



Malibu Geometric shapes were fashionable further afield than Europe, as demonstrated by the silk crêpe beach pyjamas worn by Lilyan Tashman. “Hollywood’s best-dressed star” allegedly owned a million-dollar wardrobe.